Elections

Class 9 Social Science (NCERT, Understanding Society: India and Beyond, Part 1) | Chapter 7 | Important Questions with Answers

Quick Revision

Elections: direct (Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, local bodies; every 5 years) and indirect (President, Vice President, Rajya Sabha). **Systems:** FPTP for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha; proportional representation for Rajya Sabha, President and VP; STV for Vidhan Parishad (quota = votes ÷ (seats + 1) + 1). **Laws:** RPA 1950 (seats, delimitation, rolls), RPA 1951 (conduct, offences, disputes); Delimitation Commission (Article 82; 1952, 1963, 1973, 2002). **ECI:** constitutional body, 25 Jan 1950, Articles 324–329; roll and SIR, schedule, parties and symbols, free and fair elections; apps: Suvidha, Voter Helpline, Saksham, cVIGIL. **Parties:** national, state, RUPP; Anti-Defection Law 1985 (52nd Amendment); 1977 Janata Party first coalition government. **Facts:** 96.8 crore voters; National Voters' Day 25 January; voting from home for those above 85 and PwDs (2024). **Challenges:** misinformation, fake news, intimidation.

Comparison of electoral systems

Feature	FPTP	Majority system	Proportional representation
How voting works	Vote for one candidate; most votes wins	Candidate needs more than 50%; else top two compete in 2nd round	Vote for a party; seats in proportion to votes
Sample result	A 40%, B 35%, C 25%: A forms government	X 45%, Y 40%, Z 15%: Y wins 2nd round with 55%	M 40%, N 35%, O 15%, P 10%: 40, 35, 15, 10 seats of 100

Important Questions with Answers (77)

A. Multiple Choice Questions

1. Which of the following are elected through indirect elections?
(a) Lok Sabha members (b) Vidhan Sabha members (c) President, Vice President and Rajya Sabha members (d) members of Panchayats

Ans: (c) President, Vice President and Rajya Sabha members

2. The scientific study of elections is called:
(a) sociology (b) psephology (c) civics (d) demography

Ans: (b) psephology (from the Greek psēphos, ‘pebble’)

3. Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha members are elected using the:
(a) First-Past-The-Post (FPTP) system (b) proportional representation (c) two-round majority system (d) single transferable vote

Ans: (a) First-Past-The-Post (FPTP) system

4. Rajya Sabha, President and Vice President are elected using:
(a) FPTP (b) a two-round majority system (c) the system of proportional representation (d) a nomination system

Ans: (c) the system of proportional representation

5. Which of these states does NOT have a bicameral legislature, according to the chapter?
(a) Bihar (b) Karnataka (c) Gujarat (d) Telangana

Ans: (c) Gujarat

6. The Representation of the People Act, 1950 mainly deals with:
(a) nomination of candidates and election campaigns (b) allocation of seats, delimitation of constituencies and preparation of electoral rolls (c) post-election disputes (d) presidential elections

Ans: (b) allocation of seats, delimitation of constituencies and preparation of electoral rolls

7. The Representation of the People Act, 1951 deals with:
(a) only electoral rolls (b) only delimitation (c) only the President's election (d) nomination, campaigns, voting procedures and resolution of disputes

Ans: (d) nomination, campaigns, voting procedures and resolution of disputes

8. Article 82 of the Constitution provides for the establishment of:
(a) the Election Commission (b) the Delimitation Commission (c) the Finance Commission (d) the Law Commission

Ans: (b) the Delimitation Commission

9. The Election Commission of India was established on:
(a) 26 January 1950 (b) 15 August 1947 (c) 25 January 1950 (d) 26 November 1949

Ans: (c) 25 January 1950

10. The establishment and powers of the ECI are provided for in:
(a) Articles 324 to 329 (b) Articles 14 to 18 (c) Articles 19 to 22 (d) Article 368

Ans: (a) Articles 324 to 329

11. National Voters' Day is celebrated every year on:
(a) 26 January (b) 25 January (c) 15 August (d) 2 October

Ans: (b) 25 January

12. The Anti-Defection Law was passed in 1985 through the:
(a) 42nd Amendment (b) 44th Amendment (c) 73rd Amendment (d) 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act

Ans: (d) 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act

13. Voting from home was extended across India for the first time, in the 2024 General Elections, for senior citizens above the age of:
(a) 60 years (b) 75 years (c) 85 years (d) 90 years

Ans: (c) 85 years

14. Which ECI app lets voters report Model Code of Conduct violations within minutes?
(a) Saksham (b) cVIGIL (c) Suvidha (d) Sugam

Ans: (b) cVIGIL

B. True or False

15. Members of the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha are elected directly every five years.

Ans: True

16. The President of India is elected through direct elections.

Ans: False (the President, Vice President and Rajya Sabha members are elected indirectly)

17. In the FPTP system, a candidate must get more than 50% of the votes to win.

Ans: False (the candidate with the most votes wins, even if the votes are less than 50%)

18. The Governor nominates some members of the Vidhan Parishad from fields such as art, science, literature and social service.

Ans: True

19. Independent candidates, who are not affiliated to any party, can also contest elections.

Ans: True

20. The Election Commission of India is a statutory body created by an ordinary law.

Ans: False (it is an autonomous, permanent constitutional body)

21. Appealing to people to vote on the basis of religion, caste, race, community or language is a corrupt practice.

Ans: True

22. Under the Anti-Defection Law, a member who votes against the party whip can be disqualified.

Ans: True

23. The Janata Party formed the first coalition government at the national level in 1977.

Ans: True

24. Only the people whose names are on the electoral roll are allowed to vote.

Ans: True

C. Fill in the Blanks

25. Members of the Lok Sabha are elected directly every _____ years.

Ans: five

26. Delimitation is the process of determining the number of seats and fixing the territorial _____ of constituencies.

Ans: boundaries

27. ETPBS stands for Electronically Transmitted _____ Ballot System.

Ans: Postal

28. Abandoning or switching from the party under whose banner a candidate was elected is called _____.

Ans: defection

29. In the Single Transferable Vote system, the quota = (Total valid votes ÷ (Seats to be filled + 1)) + _____.

Ans: 1

30. The ECI is an autonomous permanent _____ body.

Ans: constitutional

31. The _____ App of the ECI provides customised services to persons with disabilities.

Ans: Saksham

32. The ECI conducts the _____ Intensive Revision (SIR) to update, verify and correct the electoral rolls.

Ans: Special

33. The Representation of the People Act, 1951 lists electoral offences and _____ practices.

Ans: corrupt

34. The India's Delimitation Commissions were set up in 1952, 1963, 1973 and _____.

Ans: 2002

D. Assertion and Reason *(Options: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A. (b) Both true but R does not explain A. (c) A is true, R is false. (d) A is false, R is true.)*

35. Assertion (A): Constituency boundaries are redrawn from time to time through delimitation.
Reason (R): Shifts in population density would otherwise make some MPs represent far more people than others, defeating equal representation.

Ans: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A

36. Assertion (A): The ECI considers weather, agricultural cycles, exams and festivals while deciding the election schedule.
Reason (R): In a large and diverse country these factors can affect people's ability to vote.

Ans: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A

37. Assertion (A): India passed the Anti-Defection Law in 1985.
Reason (R): It aims to prevent defection and give stability to the elected government.

Ans: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A

38. Assertion (A): Elections in a democracy must be held periodically.
Reason (R): Periodic elections allow the people to hold their elected representatives accountable and to choose again.

Ans: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A

39. Assertion (A): The ECI conducts Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.
Reason (R): It ensures that no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included.

Ans: (a) Both A and R are true and R explains A

E. Short Answer Questions *(2 to 3 sentences)*

40. Why do elections matter in a democracy?

Ans: Regular and periodic elections lie at the core of democracy. They let citizens **choose their representatives**, hold them **accountable**, give every citizen an equal voice and make the government legitimate. A government cannot continue beyond its term without seeking people's mandate again, and people cannot exercise choice if only one party contests.

41. Differentiate between direct and indirect elections with examples.

Ans: In **direct elections** citizens vote directly for their representatives: Lok Sabha, Vidhan Sabha and local bodies (every five years). In **indirect elections** citizens vote for representatives who then elect the leaders: the President, Vice President and Rajya Sabha members.

42. What is the First-Past-The-Post (FPTP) system? Where is it used?

Ans: In FPTP (also called the plurality system) each voter votes for one candidate in the constituency and the candidate with the **most votes wins**, even if the votes are less than 50%. It is used for the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections.

43. Differentiate between the FPTP, majority and proportional representation systems.

Ans: FPTP: the candidate with the most votes wins. **Majority system:** a candidate must get more than 50% of the votes; if nobody does, the top two candidates compete again in a second round. **Proportional representation:** voters vote for a party, and seats are given to parties in proportion to the total votes each receives.

44. What is a bicameral legislature? Which states have it?

Ans: A legislature with two houses: the Upper House (Vidhan Parishad) and the Lower House (Vidhan Sabha). Six states have it: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh. The Parishad is elected by Vidhan Sabha members, local bodies, graduates and teachers, and the Governor nominates some members.

45. Explain how votes are counted and transferred in the Single Transferable Vote (STV) system.

Ans: Voters mark their preferences. First-preference votes are counted, and candidates reaching the quota (minimum votes needed) are elected. The candidate with the fewest votes is eliminated and their votes are transferred to the second preferences on those ballots. This continues until the required number of candidates are elected.

46. What are the two Representation of the People Acts and what do they deal with?

Ans: RPA, 1950: allocation of seats, delimitation of constituencies, preparation and revision of electoral rolls, and the right of every citizen above 18 to vote without discrimination. **RPA, 1951:** all other aspects, such as nomination of candidates, campaigns, voting procedures, post-election disputes, electoral offences and corrupt practices. (The Presidential and Vice-Presidential Elections Act, 1952 covers those elections.)

47. Give three examples of corrupt practices listed in the RPA, 1951.

Ans: (1) Any gift, offer or promise to a person to make them contest, withdraw, vote or refrain from voting. (2) Appealing to people to vote or not vote on the basis of religion, caste, race, community or language. (3) Taking help for the candidate from government-related personnel such as gazetted officers, judges and magistrates, armed forces, police or excise officers.

48. What is delimitation? Why is it needed?

Ans: Delimitation is the process of determining the number of seats and fixing the territorial boundaries in each state for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. It keeps the ratio of seats to population as equal as possible; otherwise one MP might represent five lakh people while another represents twenty-five lakh. Article 82 provides for a Delimitation Commission.

49. What is the Election Commission of India? What does it conduct?

Ans: The ECI is an autonomous, permanent constitutional body established on 25 January 1950 (Articles 324–329) with the superintendence, direction and control of the entire election process. It conducts elections to the Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, Vidhan Parishad, President and Vice President.

50. Who supervises election work at the state and district level?

Ans: At the state level, the **Chief Electoral Officer**, appointed by the ECI from among the civil servants in consultation with the state government. State officers such as District Magistrates, Sub-Divisional Magistrates and Tahsildars are designated as District Election Officers, Returning Officers and Electoral Registration Officers.

51. How does the ECI prepare the electoral roll? What is SIR?

Ans: The ECI sends enumerators to every household to collect data on eligible electors and prepares polling-station-wise rolls for each constituency; only those on the roll can vote. The **Special Intensive Revision (SIR)** updates, verifies and corrects the rolls so that no eligible citizen (especially youth who just turned 18) is left out and no ineligible person is included. It deletes names on account of death, change of residence, duplicate enrolment and being untraceable.

52. What factors does the ECI consider while deciding the election schedule?

Ans: When the five-year term of the legislature ends or it is dissolved early, the ECI sets the schedule keeping in mind weather conditions, the agricultural cycle, school and university examination schedules and festivals, since India is large and diverse.

53. How does the ECI register political parties and allot symbols?

Ans: Only parties registered with the ECI can contest elections (independent candidates can also contest). The ECI makes parties hold organisational elections periodically (inner-party democracy), classifies them as recognised national, state/regional or registered-unrecognised parties, and allots symbols to national and state parties. It also acts as a quasi-judicial body in disputes about recognition and symbols.

54. Describe the steps taken by the ECI to make elections inclusive.

Ans: Infrastructure accessibility and technology for PwDs, senior citizens, transgender persons and PVTGs: EVMs with Braille, wheelchairs and volunteers, the **Saksham App** for PwDs, **ETPBS** for service voters, and voting from home for senior citizens above 85 years and PwDs with 40% benchmark disability (first done across India in 2024).

55. Name any four apps/digital initiatives of the ECI and their use.

Ans: Suvidha: for candidates and parties to get nomination forms and permissions. **Voter Helpline App:** registration, verification and election information. **Saksham App:** services for PwDs. **cVIGIL:** reporting Model Code of Conduct violations. (Also **ERONET** for electoral-roll processing and **Sugam** for managing vehicles.)

56. What is the International Election Visitors' Programme?

Ans: A flagship programme of the ECI for international cooperation and engagement with Election Management Bodies of other countries and international organisations. The ECI has signed MoUs with 28 EMBs and three organisations: IFES, International IDEA and the United Nations.

57. What is the role of political parties in elections?

Ans: They organise public opinion, campaign on issues, offer voters meaningful choices, help voters make informed decisions through manifestos and rallies, and ensure governance, accountability and representation. The winning party forms the government and the opposition party ensures accountability.

58. What is defection? What does the Anti-Defection Law say?

Ans: Defection is abandoning or switching from the party under whose banner a candidate was elected, or acting against its decisions. The **Anti-Defection Law** (1985, 52nd Amendment) says that if an MP or MLA voluntarily gives up party membership or votes against the party whip, he or she can be disqualified; the Speaker or Chairman decides. Its aim is to give stability to governments.

59. What are Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPP)?

Ans: Parties that have not secured enough percentage of votes in the Legislative Assembly or General Elections, and parties that have never contested elections since their registration.

60. Write a short note on alliances in Indian elections.

Ans: The year 1967 ended single-party-dominated elections and began the era of alliances. In 1977 the Janata Party formed the first coalition government at the national level against the backdrop of the Emergency. Since the late 1990s, the NDA (led by the BJP) and the UPA (led by the INC until its dissolution in 2023 and reconstitution as INDIA) have been the main alliances.

61. What challenges are there to free and fair elections? How does the ECI address them?

Ans: Challenges include misinformation, fake news and intimidation (and the ill of money power). The ECI addresses them through the RPA 1950 and 1951, the Model Code of Conduct, EVMs, VVPAT, voters' awareness campaigns and other measures, with citizens' vigilance and participation.

F. Application and Data-based Questions

62. In a country of 100 seats, Party A gets 40%, Party B 35% and Party C 25% of the votes in each constituency. Who forms the government under FPTP and why?

Ans: Party A wins, because under FPTP the candidate (party) with the most votes wins even without 50%. No party reaches 50%, but A has the highest.

63. In a majority system, Party X gets 45%, Party Y 40% and Party Z 15% in Round 1. What happens next?

Ans: Nobody has more than 50%, so the top two, X and Y, compete again in a second round. In the example Party Y wins with 55% and forms the government.

64. In a PR system with 100 seats, Party M gets 40%, N 35%, O 15% and P 10% of the votes. How are seats allotted?

Ans: Seats are allotted in proportion to votes: M gets **40** seats, N **35**, O **15** and P **10**. Power is shared proportionately.

65. In an STV election, there are 1,00,000 valid votes and 3 seats to be filled. Find the quota (minimum votes needed to win).

Ans: Quota = (1,00,000 ÷ (3 + 1)) + 1 = 25,000 + 1 = **25,001 votes**.

66. What reforms has the ECI introduced to make voting more inclusive for (a) people with disabilities (b) service voters (c) senior citizens above 85 years?

Ans: (a) Accessible polling stations with wheelchairs and volunteers, EVMs with Braille, the Saksham App, and voting from home for those with 40% benchmark disability. (b) **ETPBS**, which lets service voters receive and cast postal ballots electronically from outside their constituency. (c) **Voting from home**, extended across India for the first time in the 2024 General Elections.

67. What are the objectives and necessity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR)?

Ans: Objectives: to update, verify and correct electoral rolls, add all eligible voters (especially those who just turned 18) and delete names of the dead, those who have changed residence, duplicate enrolments and untraceable persons. **Necessity:** only those on the roll can vote, so an accurate roll ensures free and fair elections: no eligible citizen is left out and no ineligible person is included.

68. Ishani voted for the first time. Her mother, her disabled brother and her 89-year-old grandmother also voted. Which ECI initiatives helped them? Suggest a title for the passage.

Ans: Ishani registered online through the ECI portal; her brother was helped by a wheelchair and volunteers; her identity was verified using an alternative document; she could see the VVPAT slip; and her 89-year-old grandmother voted from home (voting from home for senior citizens above 85). **Title:** “Ishani's First Vote” or “No Voter Left Behind”.

69. Differentiate between voting rights in a multi-party system and in a single-party system.

Ans: In a **multi-party system** voters can choose among several parties and candidates, and the vote decides who governs and holds them accountable. In a **single-party system** there is only one party, so the voter has no real choice and elections cannot change the government, which limits democracy.

70. Write three differences between national and state/regional parties.

Ans: (1) **Area:** a national party has support in several states; a state party is mainly confined to one state and regional interests. (2) **Recognition criteria:** a national party needs, for example, 6% of valid votes in four or more states plus four Lok Sabha seats, or 2% of Lok Sabha seats from at least three states; a state party needs, for example, 6% of valid votes in the state plus two Assembly seats. (3) **Status:** a state party can also be recognised in at least four states to become national. Both are allotted election symbols.

G. Long Answer Questions *(100 to 150 words)*

71. ‘Elections are the soul of democracy.’ Do you agree? Why?

Ans: Yes. Elections let every citizen have an equal voice in forming the government. Through regular, periodic elections people choose representatives, hold them accountable and can change non-performing ones. Governments cannot continue beyond their term without a fresh mandate, and elections make governments legitimate. They also encourage representation and equality, since each adult has one vote. Without free, fair and periodic elections, democracy would only exist in name, so elections are the soul of democracy.

72. Explain the electoral systems discussed in the chapter and the system adopted in India.

Ans: FPTP/plurality: the candidate with the most votes in the constituency wins, even without 50%. **Majority system:** a candidate needs more than 50% of votes, or the top two compete in a second round. **Proportional representation:** voters vote for parties and seats are allotted in proportion to votes; a single transferable vote with a quota is one form. The framers of our Constitution discussed the two most common systems and chose FPTP. It is used for the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha; proportional representation is used for the Rajya Sabha, President and Vice President, and the Vidhan Parishad (by single transferable vote).

73. Describe the laws that govern elections in India.

Ans: The **Representation of the People Act, 1950** deals with allocation of seats, delimitation of constituencies, preparation and revision of electoral rolls, and ensures every citizen above 18 can vote without discrimination. The **RPA, 1951** covers nomination, campaigns, voting procedure, post-election disputes, electoral offences and corrupt practices (gifts or promises to voters, appeals on religion, caste, race, community or language, and use of government personnel). The **Presidential and Vice-Presidential Elections Act, 1952** governs those elections. Together they ensure integrity, transparency and accountability.

74. Describe the functions of the Election Commission of India. Which is the most important for free and fair elections?

Ans: The ECI (1) prepares the electoral roll and conducts SIR, (2) decides the election schedule and date, (3) registers political parties and allots symbols, ensures inner-party democracy and settles disputes quasi-judicially, and (4) ensures free and fair elections through inclusive initiatives, the Model Code of Conduct, EVMs and VVPAT, and digital apps. *(Opinion-based.)* The most important is ensuring free and fair elections, because if the process is not fair, public confidence weakens, though an accurate electoral roll is its foundation.

75. What role do political parties play in a democracy? Explain defection and the Anti-Defection Law.

Ans: Political parties inform voters about issues and candidates, organise public opinion, campaign, give meaningful choices through manifestos and rallies, form the government or serve as the opposition, and make policies and ensure accountability through debates and committees. **Defection** is switching from the party on whose ticket one was elected. It may be seen as opportunism or as following one's conscience. The Anti-Defection Law (1985, 52nd Amendment) provides that a member who voluntarily gives up party membership or votes against the party whip can be disqualified by the Speaker or Chairman, to ensure the stability of governments.

76. Explain the criteria for recognition of national and state parties.

Ans: National party (any one): at least 6% of valid votes in four or more states in a Lok Sabha or Assembly general election plus four Lok Sabha seats; or at least 2% of Lok Sabha seats from at least three states; or recognition as a state party in at least four states. **State party** (any one): 6% of valid votes in the state's Assembly election plus two seats; 6% of Lok Sabha votes from the state plus one seat; 3% of Assembly seats or at least three seats; one Lok Sabha seat for every 25 allotted to the state; or 8% of valid votes in the state. Parties that fail these are **Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPP)**.

77. Why should you vote? What are the challenges to free and fair elections?

Ans: *(Opinion-based.)* I should vote because it gives me the opportunity to choose my representative and to change a non-performing one, it strengthens democracy and it makes me a responsible citizen; casting a vote is a constitutional right as well as a duty. The Voters' Pledge also asks us to vote fearlessly. The challenges to free and fair elections are misinformation, fake news, intimidation (and money power), with 96.8 crore voters spread across diverse regions. The ECI deals with them through the RPA 1950 and 1951, the Model Code of Conduct, EVMs, VVPAT and voter-awareness campaigns, and citizens' vigilance is also needed.